hw1-definitions-and-notation

CSE020F26

Due: 10/06/26 at 5pm (no penalty late submission until 8am next morning)

In this assignment,

You will practice reading and applying definitions to get comfortable working with mathematical language.

Relevant class material: Week 0 and 1.

You will submit this assignment via Gradescope (https://www.gradescope.com) in the assignment called "hw1-definitions-and-notation".

For all HW assignments: These homework assignments must be done in groups of three students. Please ensure your name(s) and TSN(s) are clearly visible on the first page of your homework submission, start each question on a new page, and upload the PDF to Gradescope. If you're working in a group, *submit only one submission per group*: one partner uploads the submission through their Gradescope account and then adds the other group members to the Gradescope submission by selecting their name(s) in the "Add Group Members" dialog box. You will need to re-add your group member(s) every time you resubmit a new version of your assignment.

All submitted homework for this class must be typed. You can use a word processing editor if you like (Microsoft Word, Open Office, Notepad, Vim, Google Docs, etc.) but you might find it useful to take this opportunity to learn LaTeX. LaTeX is a markup language used widely in computer science and mathematics. The homework assignments are typed using LaTeX and you can use the source files as templates for typesetting your solutions.

After you submit the PDF of the homework, you will meet with a TA for a Homework Q&A session. This session is a primary component of your homework score. All group members must be present and able to fully participate in discussions of each question.

Integrity reminders

- Problems should be solved together, not divided up between the partners. The homework

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is designed to give you practice with the main concepts and techniques of the course, while getting to know and learn from your classmates.

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- Do not share written solutions or partial solutions for homework with other students in the class who are not in your group. Doing so would dilute their learning experience and detract from their success in the class.

When discussing your homework solutions, you should be prepared to describe

- The key ideas that establish the correctness of any final answers.
- What evidence demonstrates the soundness of your results and methods.
- What would need to change in the solution to solve a similar but different question.

A rule of thumb for the level of detail to include is to imagine someone who is taking the class alongside you but missed about a week's worth of content: does your writeup have enough detail for them to learn from it?

To demonstrate your honest effort in answering homework questions, we expect you to include your attempt to answer *each* part of the question. If you get stuck with your attempt, you can still demonstrate your effort by explaining where you got stuck and what you did to try to get unstuck (e.g. reviewing annotated notes from class, checking the relevant textbook sections, looking up comparable questions on the relevant weekly review quizzes, asking questions on Piazza, attending (instructor/TA/tutor) office hours, consulting generative AI tools, etc.).

Assigned questions

1. Modeling

(a) In class, we used 4-tuples to represent the user ratings for four movies. This representation is memory-efficient because we use the order of the components in the 4-tuples to represent which move is being rated. However, it is not easily extended when we want to add new movies to the database. Define a new model that would allow us to represent the user ratings of movie databases where we allow for new movies to be added. Use only the data types we have talked about in class: sets, n-tuples, and strings. Explain the design choices that you used to define your model by referencing properties of the data-type(s) you choose. Demonstrate your model by showing how the rating of the user who dislikes Superman, Wicked and likes KPop Demon Hunters, A Minecraft Movie is represented.

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(b) Colors can be described as amounts of red, green, and blue mixed together [1] Mathematically, a color can be represented as a 3-tuple (r, g, b) where r represents the red component, g the green component, b the blue component and where each of r, g, b must be a value from this collection of numbers:

$\{0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50, 51, 52, 53, 54, 55, 56, 57, 58, 59, 60, 61, 62, 63, 64, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 82, 83, 84, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 95, 96, 97, 98, 99, 100, 101, 102, 103, 104, 105, 106, 107, 108, 109, 110, 111, 112, 113, 114, 115, 116, 117, 118, 119, 120, 121, 122, 123, 124, 125, 126, 127, 128, 129, 130, 131, 132, 133, 134, 135, 136, 137, 138, 139, 140, 141, 142, 143, 144, 145, 146, 147, 148, 149, 150, 151, 152, 153, 154, 155, 156, 157, 158, 159, 160, 161, 162, 163, 164, 165, 166, 167, 168, 169, 170, 171, 172, 173, 174, 175, 176, 177, 178, 179, 180, 181, 182, 183, 184, 185, 186, 187, 188, 189, 190, 191, 192, 193, 194, 195, 196, 197, 198, 199, 200, 201, 202, 203, 204, 205, 206, 207, 208, 209, 210, 211, 212, 213, 214, 215, 216, 217, 218, 219, 220, 221, 222, 223, 224, 225, 226, 227, 228, 229, 230, 231, 232, 233, 234, 235, 236, 237, 238, 239, 240, 241, 242, 243, 244, 245, 246, 247, 248, 249, 250, 251, 252, 253, 254, 255\}$

(This is the same definition as in the Week 1 Review quiz.)

Can you find two different 3-tuples that represent colors that are indistinguishable to your eye? You can use the website in the footnote to play around with different choices of red, green, and blue levels to see if you can distinguish between the resulting colors. Why or why not?

A complete answer will include the specific example 3-tuples that work, along with a description of the colors that they represent and why they are indistinguishable, or an explanation of why there can't be such an example.

2. Sets and functions

(a) Each of the sets below is described using set builder notation or recursion or as a result of set operations applied to other known sets. Rewrite each of the sets using the roster method.

Remember our discussions of data-types: use clear notation that is consistent with our class notes and definitions to communicate the data-types of the elements in each set.

Sample response that can be used as reference for the detail expected in your answer:

The set $\{\texttt{A}\} \circ \{\texttt{AU}, \texttt{AC}, \texttt{AG}\}$ can be written using the roster method as

$$\{\texttt{AAU}, \texttt{AAC}, \texttt{AAG}\}$$

because set-wise concatenation gives a set whose elements are all possible results of concatenating an element of the left set with an element of the right set. Since the left set in this example only has one element, namely A, each of the elements of the set we described

[1] This RGB representation is common in web applications. Many online tools are available to play around with mixing these colors, e.g. `https://www.w3schools.com/colors/colors_rgb.asp`.

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starts with `A`. There are three elements of this set, one for each of the distinct elements of the right set.

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i.

$$\{n \in \mathbb{Z}^+ \mid n \leq 3\} \times \{m \in \mathbb{N} \mid m \leq 3\}$$

ii. The set X defined recursively as

Basis Step:	$1 \in X, 3 \in X, 5 \in X$
Recursive Step:	If the integer $n \in X$, then the result of multiplying n by -1 is in X

iii.

$$\{x \in S \mid rnalen(x) = 2\} \circ \{x \in S \mid rnalen(x) = 0\}$$

where S is the set of RNA strands and $rnalen$ is the recursively defined function that we discussed in class,

		$rnalen : S$	$\to \mathbb{Z}^+$
Basis Step:	If $b \in B$ then	$rnalen(b)$	$= 1$
Recursive Step:	If $s \in S$ and $b \in B$, then	$rnalen(sb)$	$= 1 + rnalen(s)$

iv.

$$\{(r, g, b) \in C \mid r + g + b = 2 \text{ and } g = 1\}$$

where $C = \{(r, g, b) \mid 0 \leq r \leq 255, 0 \leq g \leq 255, 0 \leq b \leq 255, r \in \mathbb{N}, g \in \mathbb{N}, b \in \mathbb{N}\}$.

(b) Recall the function which takes an ordered pair of ratings 4-tuples and returns a measure of the difference between them

$$d_0 : \{-1, 0, 1\}^4 \times \{-1, 0, 1\}^4 \to \mathbb{R}$$

given by

$$d_0(\ (\ (x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4), (y_1, y_2, y_3, y_4)\ )\ ) = \sqrt{(x_1 - y_1)^2 + (x_2 - y_2)^2 + (x_3 - y_3)^2 + (x_4 - y_4)^2}$$

Define a **new** function which we'll call d_{new} with the same domain $\{-1, 0, 1\}^4 \times \{-1, 0, 1\}^4$ and codomain $\mathbb{R}$ but where there is some example pair of ratings 4-tuples

$$(\ (x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4), (y_1, y_2, y_3, y_4)\ )$$

where

$$d_0(\ (\ (x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4), (y_1, y_2, y_3, y_4)\ )\ ) \neq d_{new}(\ (\ (x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4), (y_1, y_2, y_3, y_4)\ )\ )$$

Your answer should include **both** a precise and clear definition for the rule defining d_{new} which unambiguously specifies output for each input of the function **and** the example ordered pair of ratings 4-tuples that demonstrate that the functions are not equal. Also include a justification of your answers with (clear, correct, complete) calculations for each of the function applications and/or references to definitions and connecting them with the desired conclusion.

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(c) A function *basecount* that computes the number of a given base b appearing in a RNA strand s is defined recursively:

$$basecount : S \times B \quad \to \mathbb{N}$$

Basis Step:

$$\text{If } b_1 \in B, b_2 \in B \qquad basecount(\ (b_1, b_2)\ ) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{when } b_1 = b_2 \\ 0 & \text{when } b_1 \neq b_2 \end{cases}$$

Recursive Step:

$$\text{If } s \in S, b_1 \in B, b_2 \in B \quad basecount(\ (sb_1, b_2)\ ) = \begin{cases} 1 + basecount(\ (s, b_2)\ ) & \text{when } b_1 = b_2 \\ basecount(\ (s, b_2)\ ) & \text{when } b_1 \neq b_2 \end{cases}$$

Consider the function application

$$basecount(\ (\texttt{ACAU}, \texttt{A})\ )$$

What is the input? What is the output? Give an example of a different choice of input that gives the same output.

Your answer should include clearly labeled answers to each of the three parts of the question, along with a justification for the values of the applications that makes specific reference to the parts of the recursive definition of the *basecount* function used to calculate it.

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hw2-numbers Due: 10/20/26 at 5pm (no penalty late submission until 8am next morning)

In this assignment,

You will practice applying functions and tracing algorithms in multiple contexts, and exploring properties of positional number representations.

Relevant class material: Week 2 and Week 3.

You will submit this assignment via Gradescope (https://www.gradescope.com) in the assignment called "hw2-numbers".

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Assigned questions

1. Functions and algorithms: in this question you'll explore the properties of the (integer) power and logarithm functions. We'll use some definitions we introduced in class and review quiz. In particular, recall the function

$$b^i$$

with domain $\mathbb{Z}^+ \times \mathbb{N}$ and codomain $\mathbb{N}$ defined recursively by

$$\text{Basis Step: } b^0 = 1$$
$$\text{Recursive Step: If } i \in \mathbb{N}, b^{i+1} = b \cdot b^i$$

Also, recall the algorithm *logb* given by the pseudocode below

Calculating integer part of base b logarithm

```
1  procedure logb(b,n: positive integers with b>1)
2  i := 0
3  while n > b-1
4    i := i+1
5    n := n div b
6  return i {i holds the integer part of the base b logarithm of n}
```

(a) Choose a positive integer b between 3 and 6 (inclusive) and choose a nonnegative integer i between 2 and 5 (inclusive). Demonstrate how to calculate the result of the *logb* algorithm (procedure) when its input is the base b you chose and $n = b^i$ (for the i you choose.) A complete answer will include the specific choice of b and i, along with trace of the calculations of b^i and the computation of the algorithm, including (clear, correct, complete) calculations

for each of the function applications and/or references to definitions and a trace table for algorithm that includes the values of all relevant variables at each iteration (See the annotated Week 2 notes and the review quiz for the level of detail expected in a trace of a function application and a trace table).

(b) Now we'll go in the other direction: Demonstrate how to calculate the result of 7^y where y is the result of the *logb* algorithm (procedure) when its input is $b = 7$ and $n = 30$. A complete answer will include clearly labelled traces of the calculations of b^i and the computation of the algorithm, including (clear, correct, complete) calculations for each of the function applications and/or references to definitions and a trace table for algorithm that includes the values of all relevant variables at each iteration (See the annotated Week 2 notes for the level of detail expected in a trace of a function application and a trace table).

(c) Logarithms and powers are supposed to "undo" one another. Explain whether your work in parts (a) and (b) supports that idea, whether you saw anything confusing or surprising about these calculations, and how to explain what you saw.

2. Base expansions

(a) Pick an integer between 50 and 1000 (inclusive) that you (or one of your group members) came across at some point this week. In a sentence or two, give some context for why you're choosing this number). Write the base expansion of your chosen number in base 2 (binary), base 3 (ternary), base 4, and base 16 (hexadecimal).

(b) What is the **smallest** width w in which they could write your chosen number in base 8 (octal) fixed-width w? Justify your answer with reference to the definitions of fixed-width expansions and relevant calculations.

(c) Express in roster method the set of numbers between 1 and 2 (exclusive) that be written without error (full precision) in binary fixed width expansion with integer part width 3 and fractional part width 2. Justify your answer with reference to the definitions of fixed-width expansions and relevant calculations.

(d) Consider the strings of 1s that have length 3, 5, 7, and 10. Calculate the numbers

$[111]_{s,3}$ $[111]_{2c,3}$
$[11111]_{s,5}$ $[11111]_{2c,5}$
$[1111111]_{s,7}$ $[1111111]_{2c,7}$
$[1111111111]_{s,10}$ $[1111111111]_{2c,10}$

Justify your answers with specific reference to the definitions of sign-magnitude and 2s complement expansions and relevant calculations and discuss any patterns you notice.

3. Multiple representations

Recall that, mathematically, a color can be represented as a 3-tuple (r, g, b) where r represents the red component, g the green component, b the blue component and where each of r, g, b must be from the collection $\{x \in \mathbb{N} \mid 0 \leq x \leq 255\}$. As an alternative representation, in this

assignment we'll use base b fixed-width expansions to represent colors as individual numbers (this definition was introduced in a recent Review quiz question).

Definition: A **hex color** is a nonnegative integer, n, that has a base 16 fixed-width 6 expansion

$$n = (r_1 r_2 g_1 g_2 b_1 b_2)_{16,6}$$

where $(r_1 r_2)_{16,2}$ is the red component, $(g_1 g_2)_{16,2}$ is the green component, and $(b_1 b_2)_{16,2}$ is the blue.

For this question, let's call the set of hex colors HC. In the Week 2 Review quiz, we explored a few different set builder definitions for HC.

(a) Rewrite the set builder definition of a set below so that it refers to colors rather than numbers: $\{c \in HC \mid c \mod 256 = 0\}$. A complete answer will justify the new set builder definition by connection with the definition of hex colors and how it impacts the colors that satisfy the specific property for this set.

(b) Rewrite the set builder definition of a set below so that it refers to colors rather than numbers: $\{c \in HC \mid c < 65536\}$. A complete answer will justify the new set builder definition by connection with the definition of hex colors and how it impacts the colors that satisfy the specific property for this set.

(c) In art, we can mix two colors to get a new color. For example, red and blue make purple, blue and yellow make green, red and yellow make orange. A mathematical definition of **hex color mixing** would be a function with domain $HC \times HC$ and codomain HC where the result of applying this function to an input (n_1, n_2) is the hex color that results from mixing the hex colors n_1 and n_2.

Sample work for a related question that can be used as reference for the detail expected in your answer: Consider the attempted mathematical definition $f_1 : HC \times HC \to HC$ given by

$$f_1(\ (n_1, n_2)\ ) = n_1 + n_2$$

We will show that this function is not well-defined so it cannot give a hex color mixing definition. The reason it is not well-defined is that the application of the rule sometimes gives values that are not in the stated codomain. To see this, we need an example input to f_1 for which the output of the rule is not in HC. Here is one such example: $(n_1, n_2) = (\ (FFFFFF)_{16,6}, (FFFFFF)_{16,6}\ )$. This example is in $HC \times HC$ because $(FFFFFF)_{16,6}$ is a nonnegative integer that has a base 16 fixed-width 6 expansion so it is a hex color. We now apply the definition of the rule in f_1:

$$\begin{aligned} f_1(\ (n_1, n_2)\ ) &= f_1((\ (FFFFFF)_{16,6}, (FFFFFF)_{16,6}\ )) = (FFFFFF)_{16,6} + (FFFFFF)_{16,6} \\ &= 2\left(15 \cdot 16^5 + 15 \cdot 16^4 + 15 \cdot 16^3 + 15 \cdot 16^2 + 15 \cdot 16^1 + 15 \cdot 16^0\right) \\ &= 2 \cdot 15 \cdot (1048576 + 65536 + 4096 + 256 + 16 + 1) = 2 \cdot 15 \cdot 1118481 = 33554430 \end{aligned}$$

This is not a hex color because it is greater than or equal to $16^6 = 16777216$, so (using the Week 2 notes on which numbers can be represented with fixed-width expansions) it does not have a hexadecimal **fixed width** 6 expansion.

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In this question, we'll look at another attempted mathematical definition for hex color mixing. We define $f_2 : HC \times HC \to HC$ given by

$$f_2(\ (n_1, n_2)\ ) = (n_1 + n_2) \textbf{ div } 2$$

This is a well-defined function. You do not need to prove this or hand it in, but it's good practice to make sure you understand why it's well-defined. Notice that the function application

$$f_2(\ (\ (FF0000)_{16,6}, (FFFE00)_{16,6}\ )\ )$$

can be calculated as:

$$\begin{aligned} f_2(((FF0000)_{16,6}, (FFFE00)_{16,6})) &= ((FF0000)_{16,6} + (FFFE00)_{16,6})) \textbf{ div } 2 \\ &= \big(\ \big(15 \cdot 16^5 + 15 \cdot 16^4 + 0 \cdot 16^3 + 0 \cdot 16^2 + 0 \cdot 16^1 + 0 \cdot 16^0\big) \\ &\quad + \ \big((15 \cdot 16^5 + 15 \cdot 16^4 + 15 \cdot 16^3 + 14 \cdot 16^2 + 0 \cdot 16^1 + 0 \cdot 16^0\big)\ \big) \textbf{ div } 2 \\ &= (16711680 + 16776704) \textbf{ div } 2 = 33488384 \textbf{ div } 2 = 16744192 \end{aligned}$$

Since this is less than $16^6 = 16777216$, we can represent it using base 16 fixed-width 6:.

$$(16744192)_{10} = 15 \cdot 16^5 + 15 \cdot 16^4 + 7 \cdot 16^3 + 15 \cdot 16^2 + 0 \cdot 16^1 + 0 \cdot 16^0 = (FF7F00)_{16,6}$$

Using the web tool `https://www.w3schools.com/colors/colors_rgb.asp`, we can verify that $(FF0000)_{16,6}$ is red, $(FFFE00)_{16,6}$ is yellow, and $(FF7F00)_{16,6}$ is orange.

Show that f_2 does not work as a hex color mixing definition by finding another ordered pair of hex colors for which the result of applying f_2 does not give the expected hex color. Include the numerical description of each colors you mention, alongside a description of them in English. Describe how you know what these colors are (if you use a web color tool, include its URL in your submission writeup; if not, describe your reasoning). Justify your example with (clear, correct, complete) calculations and/or references to definitions, and connecting them with the desired conclusion.

4. Fixed-width addition.

   (a) Choose example width 5 first summand and width 5 second summand so that in the binary fixed-width addition (adding one bit at time, using the usual column-by-column and carry arithmetic, and ignoring the carry from the leftmost column), the example satisfies all three conditions below simultaneously

   (1) When interpreting each of the summands and the result in binary fixed-width 5, the result represents the actual value of the sum of the summands **and**

   (2) when interpreting each of the summands and the sum in sign-magnitude width 5, the result represents the actual value of the sum of the summands **and**

   (3) when interpreting each of the summands and the sum in 2s complement width 5, the result represents the actual value of the sum of the summands.

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(b) Choose an example width 5 first summand and second summand so that in the binary fixed-width addition (adding one bit at time, using the usual column-by-column and carry arithmetic, and ignoring the carry from the leftmost column), the example satisfies all three conditions below simultaneously

(1) When interpreting each of the summands and the result in binary fixed-width 5, the result **does not** represent the actual value of the sum of the summands **and**

(2) when interpreting each of the summands and the sum in sign-magnitude width 5, the result **does not** represents the actual value of the sum of the summands **and**

(3) when interpreting each of the summands and the sum in 2s complement width 5, the result represents the actual value of the sum of the summands.

A complete solution will clearly specify each summand and the result of binary fixed-width addition with this choice of summands; will specify the value of each summand and the result for binary fixed-width 5, sign-magnitude width 5, and 2s complement width 5 (and include calculations connecting with the definitions of these representations to explain these values); and a conclusion connecting the calculations to the properties laid out in the question.